

SOLMERE · B BEFORE SOLMERE

SCREENPLAY · English edition · Written by HuieChen ■■■

FADE IN:

1. INT. B'S FAMILY HOME, DINING ROOM – NIGHT

B sits with her parents at a table more generous than usual. Her father pours her a drink.

FATHER

Order anything you want today.

B

We already ordered.

FATHER

Then order more.

B

You're paying?

FATHER

I am today.

MOTHER

When don't you pay?

They laugh. B likes the food. Her father checks the price on the menu.

FATHER

Once you have a good job, you can eat somewhere like this whenever you want.

MOTHER

Which is why you still need to study properly.

B

How did dinner turn into this again?

FATHER

We're not asking anything impossible.
When is your exam?

2. INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT

School and course materials cover the coffee table. B sits on the carpet while her father holds one brochure.

FATHER

This one will make it easier to find work.

B

I know.

FATHER

Don't only think about whether you like it. Our family cannot afford too many wrong turns. Decide early, before you have nowhere left to go.

B opens her notebook and writes: TUITION. EMPLOYMENT. CITY. TIME. PLAN B. After her parents go to bed, she ranks every option. The brochure she studied longest does not end up on top.

3. INT. B'S BEDROOM – LATE NIGHT

Music software fills the screen. B records a cup, then keys, then a radiator. She drags the sounds into a track. This time it works, and she smiles. Her mother opens the door.

MOTHER

Still awake? Making music again?

B

Yes. Everything else is finished.

B

Mum, do you think it sounds good?

Her mother listens carefully.

MOTHER

It does.

MOTHER

What can you do with it later?

B

Listen to it.

MOTHER

I know. I mean afterwards.

B

I'll think about that later.

After the door closes, B plays the passage from the beginning. She does not edit it again. She only listens.

4. INT. KITCHEN – NIGHT / DAY

B

Mum, have you ever wanted to do something you liked, just for yourself? Didn't you want to learn to dance?

MOTHER

That was years ago. I don't have time.

B produces her phone. She has already found nearby classes and checked her mother's Wednesday evening.

B

This one is twenty minutes away. This one is farther, but—

Her mother does not take the phone. B stops.

B

Am I arranging your life again?

MOTHER

You finally noticed.

B

Then you choose.

Her mother accepts the phone and promises to look. In a matching daytime scene later, B notices the course flyer weighted beneath a bag of vegetables. She says nothing.

5. INT. PRODUCTION STUDIO – NIGHT

Several problems arrive at once: tomorrow's location is lost, equipment has not arrived, and one person cannot attend. B edits the schedule while everyone speaks.

B

Move the location to Thursday. If the equipment is not here by eleven, use the backup. Move his section later; I'll connect the earlier material first.

TEAM MEMBER

Can that really fit?

B

Yes.

The studio starts moving again. A colleague says it is lucky she is here. B asks for dinner in return, then specifies an expensive one. They laugh.

Late at night, EXPORT COMPLETE appears. B checks the file, closes it, reopens it and checks again. Her mother texts: 'Still at work?' then, 'Don't take every problem onto yourself.' B stares at the message and continues checking.

6. INT. FAMILY DINING ROOM – EVENING

Her father passes B a job listing. The pay and benefits look strong. Lower on the page appears SOLMERE – CREATIVE INDUSTRIES – MEDIA / PRODUCTION. B scrolls through a record shop, theatre, small venues, chess club and art spaces.

MOTHER

What do you think? Is it stable?

B

There seem to be plenty of jobs. It should be stable.

A photograph of the record shop fills the screen. When her mother leans closer and asks what she is looking at, B scrolls back to the vacancy.

B

Work.

7. INT. B'S BEDROOM – NIGHT

An open suitcase lies on the bed. B's notebook lists transport, accommodation, budget, work, seven days, twelve recognitions and the return journey. Her mother helps fold clothes.

B notices a small recorder on the desk and adds it to the suitcase.

MOTHER

For work?

B

No.

MOTHER

Then why bring it?

B

For fun.

MOTHER

Don't have so much fun that you forget
the important part.

B

I know.

After her mother leaves, B scrolls past jobs to the record shop, theatre, chess club, community centre and people in the street. On the notebook's last line she writes: WHEN I COME BACK– She waits, crosses it out and closes the book.

CUT TO BLACK.